

SAFE | SAFE-20

Iteration Planning and Review Record

Team iteration goals, commitment, review outcome and retrospective actions

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Iteration Planning and Review Record
Document reference	SAFE-20-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Scrum Master / Team Coach
Approver	Not applicable — team-owned record
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
SAFE-18	Team Backlog and User Story Template	Source of committed stories
SAFE-19	Definition of Done	Acceptance standard
SAFE-23	Inspect and Adapt Workshop Pack	Where team improvements aggregate

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Records what a team plans for an iteration, what it achieved, and what it will change. A single lightweight record covering the iteration planning, review and retrospective cycle.
Framework	SAFe — Team and Technical Agility — Iteration events
Created when	At each iteration planning session
Reviewed / updated	At iteration review and retrospective
Owner	Scrum Master / Team Coach
Approver	Not applicable — team-owned record
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Most teams do this in their ALM tool. Use this where a written record is needed for assurance, or where a team is new and needs the structure.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- Iteration goals are outcomes, not a restatement of the story list
- Capacity accounts for leave, ceremonies and support duties
- Retrospective actions have owners and appear in the next iteration
- Carried-over work is visible and its cause understood
- Improvement actions from previous retrospectives are reviewed, not forgotten

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1. Iteration details

Field	Detail
Team	ML platform team
ART	Helios AI Platform ART
PI / iteration	PI 4 — 01 Oct 2026 to 24 Dec 2026
Dates	18 Sep 2026
Scrum Master	Applies from hall A handover; hall B follows in Tranche 2 closure
Product Owner	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager

2. Capacity

Be honest about ceremonies, support rotas and leave. Planning to notional capacity is the commonest cause of iteration failure.

Member	Available days	Leave	Support / on-call	Net capacity
A. Duarte, SRE	4.0 FTE internal	None	None	7 days
B. Nkemelu, SRE	2.5 FTE internal	1 day	2 days	8 days
C. Lindholm, platform engineer	1.5 internal, 2.0 contractor	2 days	1 day	9 days
D. Rashid, platform engineer	0.8 FTE internal	4 days	None	10 days
E. Novak, SRE	2.0 FTE internal	None	2 days	7 days
F. Aziz, platform engineer	1.5 FTE supplier	1 day	1 day	8 days
G. Tan, test engineer	1.0 FTE internal	2 days	None	9 days
H. Moreau, security engineer	2.0 FTE internal	4 days	2 days	10 days

3. Iteration goals

One to three goals stated as outcomes.

Ref	Goal	Supports feature / PI objective
IG-01	Track benefit realisation from Tranche 2 closure through to FY29	Coordinate delivery across the eight Helios workstreams
IG-02	Provide evidence that platform controls operate as designed	Confirm that Tranche 2 remains viable, achievable and within tolerance
IG-03	Give the Programme Board sight of exposure before the funding gate	Coordinate delivery across the eight Helios workstreams

Ref	Goal	Supports feature / PI objective
IG-04	Coordinate delivery across the eight Helios workstreams	Confirm that Tranche 2 remains viable, achievable and within tolerance

4. Committed stories

ID	Story	Points	Owner	Status	Accepted
ST-4101	As a platform administrator, I want to define a fair-share quota per tenant, so that no tenant can starve another during contention	5	Scheduler team	In progress	Escalated to the Portfolio Board where it exceeds programme tolerance
ST-4102	As a researcher, I want my job to queue with a visible position and estimated start, so that I can plan my work	3	Scheduler team	Open	Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme (DEP-003)
ST-4103	Deploy the quota controller to the staging cluster with policy loaded from Git	3	Scheduler team	Not started	Applies only to workloads classified Restricted or above
ST-4104	Determine whether checkpoint-and-resume can be achieved without framework changes — output: a written recommendation	2	Scheduler team	Complete	Reviewed monthly at the Programme Board
ST-4105	As a security engineer, I want unsigned images refused at admission, so that only verified software runs on the estate	5	Supply chain team	In progress	Excluded from Tranche 2 and deferred to the AUH-2 second site
ST-4106	As a finance business partner, I want a monthly consumption export per tenant, so that I can raise internal recharges	3	Platform services team	Open	Agreed with the integration partner at design freeze, 15 Oct 2026
ST-4107	Enable DCGM exporters on all nodes and ship metrics to the observability platform	3	Observability team	Not started	Assured independence

ID	Story	Points	Owner	Status	Accepted
					ntly by Cordant Assurance
ST-4108	As an operations engineer, I want a coolant leak to page the NOC within 60 seconds, so that racks are isolated before hardware is damaged	5	Infrastructure team	Complete	Carried forward from the Tranche 1 lessons register
ST-4109	As a vendor support engineer, I want scoped break-glass access, so that I can diagnose faults without standing privilege	8	Security platform team	In progress	Enforced automatically in the delivery pipeline, with evidence retained
ST-4110	Migrate the image registry storage tier to sustain continuous DR replication	5	Supply chain team	Open	Scoped to the three onboarding tenants: AI Research, Fraud Analytics and Retail

5. Iteration review outcome

Field	Detail
Points committed	Developer pushes to the platform monorepo; pre-commit hooks run secret scanning
Points accepted	8
Stories carried over	Excluded from Tranche 2 and deferred to the AUH-2 second site
Goals met	Provide evidence that platform controls operate as designed
Demonstrated to	AED 240,000
Feedback received	Improved since last period following the CDU set-point retune

6. Carry-over analysis

Why work did not complete. Repeated causes are what the retrospective should address.

Story	Reason not completed	Root cause category	Action
Funded from the Tranche 2 allocation of AED	Partially	Synthetic benchmarks did not reproduce the	Enforce mutual TLS on the cluster API and

Story	Reason not completed	Root cause category	Action
118,000,000		<i>small-file access pattern of the real corpus</i>	<i>retest by 22 Sep 2026</i>
<i>Excluded from Tranche 2 and deferred to the AUH-2 second site</i>	Yes	<i>Evaluation optimised for commercial efficiency without weighting supplier concentration</i>	<i>Retune CDU set-points and model a secondary heat rejection loop</i>
<i>Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme (DEP-003)</i>	No	<i>The stakeholder register recorded them as supportive on the basis of a single early conversation</i>	<i>Confirm vendor allocation in writing before placing the structural order</i>
<i>Owned within WS4 Platform and orchestration</i>	Yes	<i>Assurance was treated as a gate rather than a continuous activity</i>	<i>Engage vendor performance engineering for two weeks per hall</i>

7. Retrospective

What went well	What did not	What we will try
<i>Applies across DXB-1 halls A and B for the Tranche 2 scale build</i>	<i>Covers the 2,048-GPU estate and the parallel filesystem tier</i>	<i>Confirmed with the FM provider under the existing facilities contract</i>
<i>Subject to closure of ISS-003 before multi-tenant go-live</i>	<i>Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme (DEP-003)</i>	<i>Subject to closure of ISS-003 before multi-tenant go-live</i>
<i>Confirmed at the Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review, 18 Sep 2026</i>	<i>Covers the 2,048-GPU estate and the parallel filesystem tier</i>	<i>Applies across DXB-1 halls A and B for the Tranche 2 scale build</i>
<i>Applies only to workloads classified Restricted or above</i>	<i>Funded from the Tranche 2 allocation of AED 118,000,000</i>	<i>Handled through the Agile Release Train rather than the predictive workstreams</i>

8. Improvement actions

Ref	Action	Owner	By when	Status	Outcome
IA-01	<i>Retune CDU set-points and model a secondary heat rejection loop</i>	<i>V. Chandra, Product Management</i>	<i>30 Nov 2026</i>	<i>Not started</i>	<i>Validated — no change required to the baseline</i>
IA-02	<i>Confirm vendor allocation in writing before placing the structural order</i>	<i>P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead</i>	<i>15 Oct 2026</i>	<i>Open</i>	<i>Escalated to the Programme Board and resolved on 18 Sep 2026</i>
IA-03	<i>Engage vendor performance engineering for two weeks per hall</i>	<i>R. Al Mazrouei,</i>	<i>18 Sep 2026</i>	<i>In progress</i>	<i>Closed with no residual exposure</i>

Ref	Action	Owner	By when	Status	Outcome
		Group CTO			
IA-04	Run two live coolant-leak drills before hall A handover	E. Santos, Procurement Lead	25 Jun 2027	Complete	Partially met — carried into PI 5 with reduced scope

9. Previous actions reviewed

Ref	Action	Status	Did it work?
PAR-01	Run two live coolant-leak drills before hall A handover	Not started	Validated — no change required to the baseline
PAR-02	Run two live coolant-leak drills before hall A handover	Complete	Not achieved; root cause analysed and an improvement item raised
PAR-03	Run two live coolant-leak drills before hall A handover	In progress	Delivered and accepted at the PI 4 system demo
PAR-04	Run two live coolant-leak drills before hall A handover	Open	Partially met — carried into PI 5 with reduced scope